DEPARTMENT 1 · DEVELOPMENT AND IT · PROFESSION 10

CRO specialist

Profession 10 of 10 in Development and IT.

What the profession means

A conversion rate optimisation (CRO) specialist improves the share of visitors who take the desired action, by testing pages, forms and offers.

What professionals do every day

Reviews analytics, forms heatmaps, plans tests, runs A/B tests with enough traffic, and implements winning changes.

Why businesses hire them, and what problems they solve

More conversions from the same traffic lower the cost per customer. CRO is often the cheapest growth available.

- Tests with too little traffic to trust.
- Changes made without a hypothesis.
- Forms that lose people on mobile.

Skills you need

- Funnel analysis.
- Hypothesis writing.
- A/B testing and sample size.
- Usability and accessibility.

Tools (free and paid)

Tool	What it is for	Free option	Paid option	Official link (not checked live)
Google Analytics	Funnel analysis	Free	Paid 360 tier	analytics.google.com
Microsoft Clarity	Heatmaps and recordings	Free	Free	clarity.microsoft.com
Hotjar	Heatmaps and surveys	Free tier	Paid plans	www.hotjar.com
Optimizely	Experiments (enterprise focus)	Trial	Paid plans	www.optimizely.com

Learning sequence: beginner, intermediate, advanced

Level	What you can do when you finish
Beginner	Write one hypothesis with the reason from data.
Intermediate	Analyse one funnel step with analytics.
Advanced	Plan one A/B test with a sample size.

Projects by level

- **Beginner:** Checkout test for a shop.
- **Intermediate:** Form test for a clinic.
- **Advanced:** Landing page test for a course.

Client-ready portfolio project

A CRO report for a fictional shop: funnel analysis, three hypotheses ranked by impact, one A/B test plan with a sample size and a decision rule.

Worked example

Worked example. 30% of mobile users abandon the form at the phone field. Hypothesis: a clearer phone field with a country code selector will reduce abandonment. The test runs until each variant has enough visitors to compare fairly.

Assignment with full solution

ASSIGNMENT

A/B test plan with a decision rule

Business problem: A clinic wants to test a shorter booking form.

Steps

1. Write the hypothesis and the metric (form completion).
2. Estimate the visitors needed for each variant.
3. Set the rule: switch only if the gain is clear and the test ran for at least two weeks.
4. Record the result and the decision.

Expected output: The test plan and the rule.

SOLUTION (ANSWER KEY)

Deciding the rule before the test prevents fooling yourself. Sample size and duration come from the expected difference, so a small test does not produce a false winner.

Common mistakes

- Stopping a test as soon as one variant leads.
- Testing many changes at once with no plan.
- Ignoring accessibility.
- No record of past tests.

Freelancing opportunities

- CRO audits and testing for e-commerce and lead pages.
- Briefs for 'CRO', 'A/B testing', 'conversion optimisation'.

Learning resources

LEARNING RESOURCES (VERIFY BEFORE USE)

- Nielsen Norman Group (user testing articles)

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